

AKSHAY R

Security Engineer | Incident Response & Threat Detection | Cloud Security

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security Engineer with 7+ years of hands-on experience driving Security Incident Response, Threat Detection & Hunting, and Cloud Security across on-premises and multi-cloud (AWS/Azure/GCP) environments. Proven track record of reducing mean time to respond (MTTR), cutting false positive rates by 40%, and leading enterprise-wide containment during zero-day events. Expert in SIEM (Azure Sentinel, Google Chronicle, QRadar) and EDR (Cortex XDR, CrowdStrike Falcon) platforms; skilled in SOAR automation, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection engineering, and translating complex threat findings into executive-level reporting. Holds AZ-500 certification; actively pursuing CEH & CompTIA Security+.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Incident Response & Triage: Alert investigation, malware analysis, phishing response, containment, root cause analysis, escalation, on-call

Threat Detection & Hunting: SIEM use case development, MITRE ATT&CK correlation tuning, GuardDuty, CrowdStrike Falcon, Wiz Defend, Darktrace, IPS/IDS

SIEM / EDR / SOAR: Azure Sentinel, Google Chronicle, IBM QRadar, Cortex XDR, SOAR automation, custom parser development

Cloud & Systems Security: AWS (GuardDuty, CloudTrail, S3, EC2, IAM), Azure, GCP, Linux/Unix, Windows, network protocol analysis (HTTP, DNS, TCP/IP)

Scripting & Automation: Python, log analysis, command-line forensics, SAST/DAST integration, DevSecOps pipelines

Frameworks & Compliance: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, vulnerability management, risk assessment, SOP development, penetration testing concepts

AI & ML in Security: ML-based anomaly detection, AI-enhanced SIEM/SOAR triage, phishing and endpoint anomaly scoring (POC)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Analyst – Cybersecurity Practitioner | Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) *Sep 2024 – Present*

- ▶ **Orchestrated end-to-end incident response** across endpoint, network, and cloud environments — owning full lifecycle from alert triage and forensic investigation to containment and root cause analysis, fully aligned with the **NIST Incident Response Framework**.
- ▶ **Slashed analyst response times** by designing and deploying SOAR-driven triage workflows and standardized playbooks, **cutting MTTR significantly** and enabling consistent SOC performance at scale.
- ▶ **Proactively neutralized advanced threats** through targeted threat hunting campaigns built on the **MITRE ATT&CK framework**, uncovering lateral movement, persistence techniques, and living-off-the-land (LotL) attacks across enterprise environments before they escalated.
- ▶ **Reduced organizational risk exposure** by leading vulnerability assessments and patch validation cycles; delivered data-driven risk dashboards and executive reports that directly informed leadership security investment decisions.
- ▶ **Strengthened detection posture** by partnering with cross-functional engineering teams to refine detection logic, improve alert fidelity, and implement preventive controls — eliminating recurring incident patterns.
- ▶ **Authored high-impact incident reports** including breach communications and detailed root cause analyses consumed by senior stakeholders and client leadership, demonstrating ability to translate technical findings into business context.

Technical Consultant – Endpoint & Infrastructure Security | IBM

Dec 2021 – Sep 2024

- ▶ **Conducted deep-dive forensic investigations** on Linux/Unix and Windows platforms — dissecting system logs, process trees, and network flows to identify IOCs and attacker TTPs, enabling rapid and accurate incident escalation.

- ▶ **Unified and automated the detection pipeline** by integrating SIEM and SOAR tools for alert correlation, threat enrichment, and case management; built custom log parsers that normalized multi-source data and improved detection precision.
- ▶ **Reduced false positives by 40%** by re-engineering SIEM detection rules and correlation use cases, dramatically cutting analyst alert fatigue and allowing the SOC team to focus on genuine threats.
- ▶ **Embedded security left in the SDLC** by participating in DevSecOps pipelines integrating SAST/DAST tooling, enabling application teams to identify and remediate vulnerabilities before production deployment.
- ▶ **Investigated high-severity EDR alerts** from CrowdStrike Falcon and similar platforms; produced comprehensive investigation reports that guided executive decision-making during critical security events.
- ▶ **Quantified and communicated detection gaps** through regular metrics reporting on detective control effectiveness and remediation progress, influencing resource prioritization and control investment.

SOC Analyst – Security Administrator (P2) | Microland

May 2021 – Dec 2021

- ▶ **Delivered 24/7 enterprise security monitoring** using IBM QRadar and Palo Alto Cortex XDR, providing first-line triage, analysis, and escalation of security events with minimal business disruption.
- ▶ **Contained and remediated malware infections** across endpoints through rapid isolation and response procedures, preserving business continuity during active threat scenarios.
- ▶ **Built executive-facing dashboards** and incident trend reports that communicated security posture, threat patterns, and KPIs to management, enabling informed security governance decisions.

System Engineer – Security Operations | Byju's

Mar 2019 – May 2021

- ▶ **Monitored and triaged security alerts** from AV, email security gateways, and perimeter firewalls; escalated confirmed incidents with well-documented findings to senior analysts for fast resolution.
- ▶ **Hardened system attack surfaces** by enforcing baseline configurations across servers and endpoints, directly reducing the organization's exposure to commodity threats.
- ▶ **Contributed to post-incident reviews** by supporting network traffic analysis, containment activities, and documentation — accelerating the team's ability to learn from and prevent incident recurrence.

NOTABLE PROJECTS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- ▶ **Zero-Day Triage & Response:** Led live enterprise containment during an active zero-day exploit — performed real-time malware reverse engineering, coordinated cross-team remediation, and authored a post-incident report with actionable preventive recommendations adopted org-wide.
- ▶ **Detection Rule Optimization (40% FP Reduction):** Redesigned SIEM correlation logic across multiple use cases, improving alert fidelity by 40% and measurably reducing analyst burnout from false positive fatigue.
- ▶ **AI-SOAR Integration POC:** Designed and evaluated an ML-based scoring model for phishing email and endpoint behavioral anomalies, integrated directly into SOAR playbooks — demonstrating potential to further reduce triage time.
- ▶ **SOC Playbook Standardization:** Authored a unified SOC playbook and SOP library adopted organization-wide, improving analyst response consistency, reducing onboarding ramp time, and establishing a repeatable incident response foundation.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering – Computer Science
Diploma – Computer Science

Visvesvaraya Technological University
Board of Technical Examinations, Bengaluru

CERTIFICATIONS

- ▶ Microsoft Certified: AZ-500 – Azure Security Engineer Associate
- ▶ Microsoft Certified: AZ-900 – Azure Fundamentals
- ▶ IBM QRadar SIEM Foundation
- ▶ Palo Alto Cortex XDR: Architecture, Analytics & Threat Hunting
- ▶ CEH (Certified Ethical Hacker) – In Progress
- ▶ CompTIA Security+ – In Progress